MIL-H-36799A
19 June 1973
SUPERSEDING
MIL-H-36799
30 September 1971

HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Brown

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a suture needle holder of the Brown design suitable for accurate retention of small suture needles near the tip of the jaw and grasping fine suture material in the central area of the jaws.

* 1.2 Classification. Suture needle holders shall be of the following sizes, as indicated below (see 6.2).

Sizes

I - 5-1/4 inch

II - 6-3/4 inch

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Specifications and standards. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. These documents may be obtained as directed by the contracting officer.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Box, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Set-up.

FSC 6515

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case, and Sheet Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards, required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General Requirements. The needle holder shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526 and the following option exercises under that specification:

3.2 Material. The needle holder shall be fabricated from Class 4, Type 410 or 420 material.

3.3 Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the needle holder shall have a Rockwell hardness of C40 to C45, with the exception of the screw or pin.

3.4 Style, design and dimensions. Shall be a suture needle holder of the Brown design, with serrated jaws adjusted so as to be suitable for accurate retention of small suture needles near the tip of the jaws, and grasping of fine suture material (size 6-0, average diameter of 0.002 to 0.004 inch) in the central area of the jaws. Shall be in accordance with Figure 1.

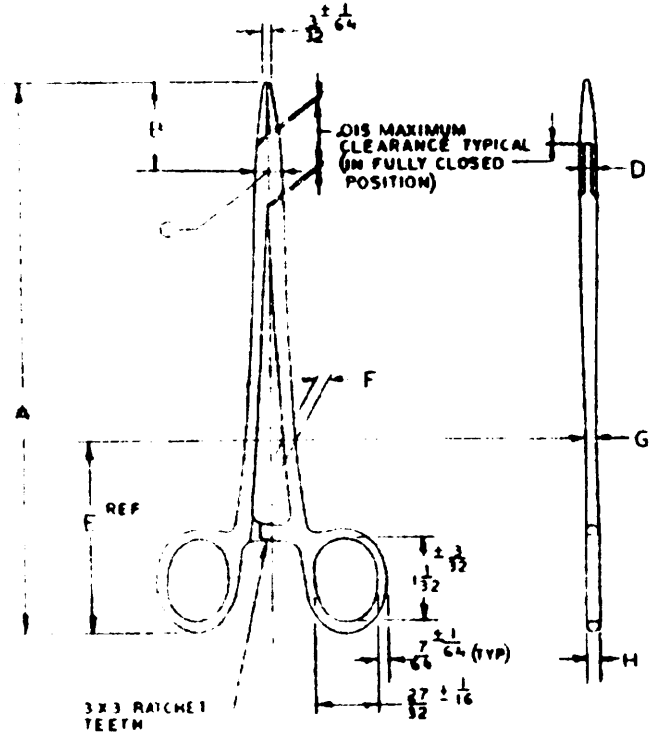
3.4.1 Locks. Shall be box type lock.

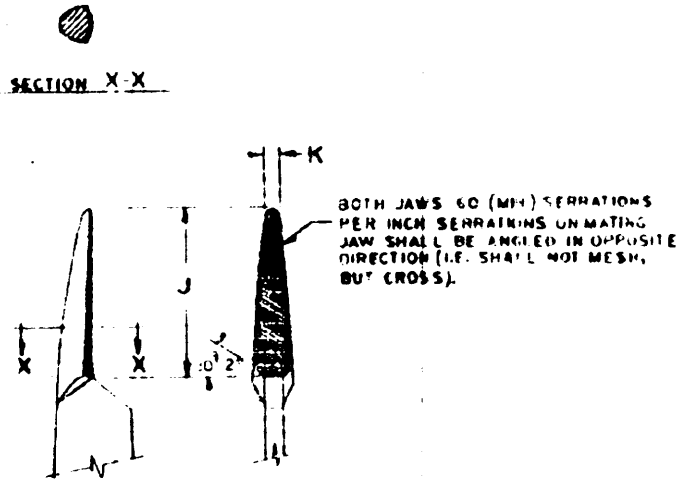
3.5 Finish. Finish shall be mirror.

3.6 Lock stiffness. Forceps of box lock construction shall have shanks tested for lock stiffness in accordance with GG-I-526.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.





NSN	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	J	K
6515-00-584-3736	5 ± 1/4	15/16	5/16	3/16	1 3/4	1/8	3/32	1/8	9/16 ± 1/32	1/16 +0 −1/64
6515-00-599-3744	7 ± 1/4	1 3/32	3/8	7/32	2 1/4	5/32	1/8	3/32	11/16 ± 1/32	1/16 +1/64 −0

NOTES
TOLERANCES INDICATED DELINEATE ACCEPTABLE EXTREME DIMENSIONS, AND ARE NOT INTENDED TO PERMIT VARIATIONS WITHIN A SINGLE INSTRUMENT WHICH WILL SACRIFICE UNIFORMITY, SYMMETRY, AND FIRST QUALITY WORKMANSHIP.

UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES AND TOLERANCE ON DIMENSIONS IS ± 1/64 INCH.

MIL-H-3073

HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE

FIGURE 1

3.7 Identification marking. In addition to GG-I-526 requirements, needle holders of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with GG-I-526.

4.1.2 Records. Records of examination and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion resisting steel may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificates shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the FSN, the Item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, the individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one suture needle holder.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I. Sampling Criteria for Examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (Percent defective
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table II. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one suture needle holder.

Table II. Sampling Criteria for Tests

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Insp. level	AQL
1-Holder	Composition analysis	3.2 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	**	*
	Hardness	3.3 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	*
	Dimensions	3.4	-----	S-2	2.5
	Needle retention	3.4	4.4.1	S-2	*
	Suture grasping	3.4	4.4.2	S-2	*
	Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	*
	Copper sulfate	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	*
	Box lock stiffness	3.6	GG-I-526	S-2	*

* Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.
** Four ounces of each lot of metal used in the construction of the suture needle holder shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3 Examination. The suture needle holder shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Table I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any suture needle holder in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective items in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for test sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table III. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None Defined.
Major	
101	Style and design not as specified.
102	Holder not free from cracks, pits, dents, nicks, sharp edges and burrs.
103	Serrations not as specified.
104	Ratchet teeth not uniform, or function poorly.
105	Holder not of box lock design.
106	Holder not free from excessive play in box lock area.
Minor	
201	Finish not mirror, and not uniform.
202	Identification marking not present, correct, complete or legible.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Needle retention test. The small suture needle with axis held perpendicularly to axis of jaws shall, upon engagement of third ratchet of the holder, show no lateral, rotational, or longitudinal motion when such yielding is attempted by hand.

4.4.2 Suture grasping test. A single thread of size 6-0 suture shall be inserted perpendicular to the axis of the jaw. The third ratchet shall be engaged and a tensile force of 0.5 pounds shall be applied perpendicular to the axis of the jaws, along the suture.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One holder as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table IV. Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	6 units	288 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Cleaning and drying. Each unit shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable method as outlined in MIL-P-116.

5.1.3.2 Preservative. Preservative shall not be utilized.

5.1.3.3 Intimate wrap. Each unit shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive material.

5.1.3.4 Unit package. Each unit shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1.

5.1.3.5 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, except commercial colors will be acceptable, or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening under normal handling.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

* 5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in Table II of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.3 Closure. Closure of wood boxes shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification. Closure of each fiberboard box shall be as specified in the appendix, and waterproofing shall conform with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.4 Strapping. Strapping, when required, shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification.

NOTE: Strapping shall not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 Level B.

* 5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method II as specified in PPP-B-636. In addition, fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in Table I of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The suture needle holder is to be used for accurate retention of small needles and also for tying knots in fine suture material in the practice of general and plastic surgery.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number, title and date of this specification.
(b) Size required. (See 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

* 6.3 National Stock Number (NSN) coverage. This specification covers the following items listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-584-3736	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Brown, 5-1/4 inch
6515-00-584-3744	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Brown, 6-3/4 inch

It does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

* 6.4 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the previous issue.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DH

Project No. 6515-1741

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 1426 82 MAR

PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-LS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T09:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.